

IDEATION PHASE

EMPATHIZE & DISCOVER

Date	25 September 2026
Team ID	_____
Project Name	Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

1. Empathy Map Canvas

An empathy map is a simple visual tool used to understand a user's behaviors, thoughts, feelings, needs, and challenges. It helps the project team look at a problem from the user's perspective rather than beginning with a technical solution.

For the Automated Network Request Management project, the empathy mapping activity is used to understand how employees, IT administrators, network fulfillment teams, and approvers experience the network request process. The insights obtained from this activity help identify user needs and opportunities for improvement.

2. User / Customer

Primary User: End User / Network Requester

An employee or authorized user who needs to submit a network-related request such as VPN access, network access, firewall access, IP allocation, VLAN request, port activation, or another network service.

The requester wants to submit a request correctly, provide the necessary information, receive approval where required, and know the status of the request until completion.

3. Empathy Map Canvas

USER / CUSTOMER: End User / Network Requester		
SAYS “I want a simple way to submit my network request.” “Which network request type should I choose?” “What information do I need to provide?” “How long will my request take?” “Has my request been approved?” “Who is handling my request?” “I want an update when my request is completed.”	THINKS - Did I submit the request correctly? - Did I provide all the required information? - Who needs to approve my request? - Why is my request still pending? - When will the network team start working on it? - Will I have to contact IT again for an update? - What happens after I submit the request?	DOES - Searches for the correct request process. - Contacts IT or the network team directly. - Sends an email or submits a manual request. - Provides business and technical information. - Waits for approval. - Responds to clarification questions. - Follows up for request status. - Waits for the request to be fulfilled. - Confirms whether the requested service is available.
FEELS - Confused when the request process is unclear. - Frustrated when information has to be provided repeatedly. - Uncertain when request status is not visible. - Concerned about delays. - Anxious when approval is pending. - Dissatisfied when communication is slow. - Relieved when the request is completed successfully.	PAINS - Manual submission – users must determine the correct process and communicate details manually. - Unclear request categories – users are unsure which request type applies to their need. - Incomplete information – requests may be missing details needed for processing. - Repeated data entry – users may re-explain the same information more than once. - Approval delays – requests may wait longer due to manual approval coordination. - Lack of status visibility – users cannot see where their request currently stands. - Repeated follow-ups – users must check in themselves to get an update. - Unclear request ownership – users may not know who is handling their request. - Delayed communication – updates may take time to reach the user. - Difficulty tracking history – past requests are hard to locate.	GAINS - Simple request submission – an easy, guided way to start a request. - Clear network service categories – requesters can easily pick the right request type. - Guided request forms – forms that indicate exactly what information is needed. - Required information validation – fewer requests are returned for missing details. - Faster approval processing – approvals are handled through a consistent process. - Automatic notifications – users are informed as their request progresses. - Real-time request status – users can check progress without contacting IT. - Clear ownership – users know who is responsible at each stage. - Transparent request history – past requests are easy to review. - Predictable request fulfillment – consistent handling builds user confidence.

4. Stakeholder Empathy Summary

Stakeholder	What They Need	Major Pain Point	Desired Outcome
End Users / Requesters	Simple request submission and status visibility.	Unclear processes, repeated follow-ups, lack of status information.	Easy submission and transparent request tracking.
IT Administrators	Efficient request management and reduced manual coordination.	Repeated administrative tasks and manual routing.	Standardized and manageable request processes.
Network Fulfillment Team	Complete and accurate request information.	Incomplete information and repeated clarification.	Well-structured requests that can be processed efficiently.
Approvers	Clear request information and approval visibility.	Manual approval communication and pending approvals.	Consistent and traceable approval process.

5. User Needs Identified from Empathy Mapping

1. Users need a clear way to identify the correct network service.
2. Users need a simple request submission process.
3. Users need guidance about required information.
4. Users need visibility into request progress.
5. Users need timely notifications.
6. Network teams need complete request information.
7. IT administrators need reduced repetitive coordination.
8. Approvers need clear approval information.
9. Stakeholders need a consistent request history.
10. The organization needs better traceability of network requests.

6. Empathy Insights

Observation	User Need	Insight	Opportunity
Users may repeatedly ask IT about request status.	Status visibility.	Lack of transparent status information can create unnecessary follow-up communication.	Provide centralized request status tracking.
Network teams may need to request missing information.	Complete request information.	Unstructured information collection can create rework.	Use guided request forms and required fields.
Approvers may receive requests requiring manual coordination.	Clear approval process.	Inconsistent approval communication can delay request processing.	Use structured approval routing.
Requesters may be unsure which request category applies.	Clear service categorization.	Ambiguous categories can lead to misrouted or incorrect requests.	Provide a standardized network request catalog.
Users may contact IT multiple times for the same request.	Reduced repeated communication.	Repeated contact increases workload for both users and IT staff.	Introduce automated status notifications.
Fulfillment staff may handle requests without full context.	Complete task assignment details.	Missing context can slow down fulfillment and cause errors.	Standardize request data captured at submission.
Past requests may be difficult to locate for reference.	Accessible request history.	Limited traceability makes reporting and review difficult.	Maintain a centralized, searchable request history.

7. Key Discoveries

- The user needs a simple and standardized request process.
- Requesters want visibility into the progress of their requests.
- Network teams need complete and relevant request information.
- IT administrators need to reduce repetitive coordination.
- Approvers need clear and traceable approval requests.
- Stakeholders benefit from timely and consistent communication.
- Request history and traceability are important for controlled network services.

8. Opportunities Identified

Based on the empathy exercise, the following areas for future exploration have been identified. These are potential opportunities, not implemented features:

1. Standardized Network Request Catalog
2. Guided Request Forms
3. Required Field Validation
4. Automated Request Routing
5. Structured Approval Process
6. Automated Notifications & Status Tracking
7. Centralized Request History & Audit Trail
8. Reporting and Analytics

9. Empathize & Discover Outcome

The Empathize & Discover activity helped the project team understand the perspectives of network requesters, IT administrators, network fulfillment teams, and approvers. Common pain points emerged — unclear processes, incomplete information, approval delays, repeated follow-ups, and limited visibility — providing a user-centered foundation for defining problem statements and generating solutions in the next Ideation activities.